

```
usage: vmstat [-V] [-n] [delay [count]]
-V prints version.
-n causes the headers not to be reprinted regularly.
-a print inactive/active page stats.
-d prints disk statistics
-D prints disk table
-p prints disk partition statistics
-s prints vm table
-m prints slabinfo
-S unit size
delay is the delay between updates in seconds.
unit size k:1000 K:1024 m:1000000 M:1048576 (default
is K) count is the number of updates.
```

9.3.2 Changing Priority Of A Process

Commands are designed to change the priority of processes in order to speed up the task for which a process is called. For instance, compressing a big file using bzip2 compressing tool can consume some time. A user can either initiate this command with '*nice*' preceding it or use '*renice*' to alter the priority after the bzip2 process is initiated. The syntax of the command is shown below:

```
#nice -n -12 tar -jcvf bigfile.tar.bz2 bigfile + [Enter]
```

The priority levels can be defined between 0 (lowest) and 20 (highest)

If the application is already running and you want to make it faster by increasing the priority and allowing it to consume more resources then:

```
#renice -15 `pidof bzip2` {Note: [`] is a back tick found on the key with tilde ([~])}
```

pidof will feed the process id number of bzip2 to renice command.

Also remember that assigning highest priority to a process will make the keyboard and mouse sluggish and sometimes they may not respond. So, priority of up to 15 is considered safe.

9.3.3 Some Useful Stuff

LSPCI

It is a command line utility to display information of all the PCI devices on your machine. This is particularly useful to find drivers